

Determinatives as nouns in English

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Abstract

I argue that English determinatives belong within Noun as a fourth coordinate subcategory alongside common nouns, proper nouns and pronouns. Their overlapping profiles across semantics, syntax and morphology support this broader category, while systematic differences support its internal divisions. Shared argument and determiner uses, referential distinctions, number and genitive marking, and nominal dependents contribute to the comparison. Adverbial premodification and grade give determinatives a distinctive profile with adjectival affinities. Including them within Noun makes nominal projection an inherited property and permits a more uniform analysis of their independent uses. A matched grammatical fragment examines these structural consequences and their costs against separate-D alternatives.

Keywords: determinatives, nouns, lexical categories, noun phrases, English

I THE QUESTION

What is the categorial relationship among words such as *some*, *me*, *apple* and *Brett*? I argue that all four are nouns, and that determinatives form a coordinate subcategory alongside common nouns, proper nouns and pronouns. I call this fourfold proposal the DETERMINATIVE-NOUN or D-NOUN ANALYSIS.

I adopt the general framework of *The Cambridge grammar of the English language* (CGEL; Huddleston and Pullum 2002). Unlike CGEL, though, I include determinatives within Noun. The claims concern synchronic English lexical categories.¹

I use DETERMINATIVE for the category containing articles, demonstratives and quantifiers such as *the*, *this*, *some*, *every* and *many*.² I reserve DETERMINER for the syntactic function within the noun phrase characteristically performed by phrases headed by these words. This distinction separates what kind of word *some* is from what syntactic relationships its phrase participates in.

I argue that the combined semantic, syntactic and morphological similarities among these four groups justify one superordinate category, which I write as Noun.

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¹I treat these categories as language-specific: a classification supported by another language's grammar doesn't determine the English classification.

²For a fuller inventory, see the online "[List of determinatives in English](#)" accompanying Huddleston et al. (2022).

CGEL already includes pronouns within the superordinate Noun category, along with common and proper nouns, on the basis of their phrases' functions, despite differences in inflection and dependents (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 327–328). The inclusion of auxiliaries within Verb supplies a further precedent for preserving distinctive syntax within a broader lexical category (Pullum & Wilson, 1977).

In the D-noun analysis, determinatives inherit the nominal projection rules of Noun. Under these rules, a determinative heads a NOMINAL (Nom), which heads an NP, just as common nouns, proper nouns and pronouns do. Nom contains the head and its internal dependents, excluding an external determiner. Lexical restrictions govern which uses are available.

Figure 1 compares *CGEL* with the D-noun analysis for *take some apples* and *take some*. Both keep *some* in one lexical category across uses. In *CGEL*, independent *some* jointly fills determiner and head functions, a FUSION OF FUNCTIONS (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 410–412). As a syntactic representation, fusion of functions appears to have seen little adoption outside work based on *CGEL*. In the D-noun analysis, *some* heads its own NP through a Nom in both uses.

Here DP abbreviates DETERMINATIVE PHRASE, as in *CGEL*, not to be confused with the DP of the DP hypothesis, where D heads the whole expression *some apples* (Abney, 1987; §2.1). The D-noun analysis keeps *apples* as that expression's ultimate head.

The English article–pronoun boundary has long been contested. Palmer (1924) groups “determinative adjectives” with pronouns; Postal (1966) analyses personal pronouns as articles at an intermediate level of representation; Sommerstein (1972) gives the definite article and pronouns underlying NP structure. Hudson places his determining words within pronoun and pronoun within noun (Hudson, 2004, 2010).

Ordinary Head structure unifies the bare, partitive and externally determined uses that *CGEL* divides between Det–Head and Mod–Head fusion. Replacing DP with NP also shares a phrase type across determinatives, genitives and minor nominal determiners. A separate-D grammar can share these structures. Including determinatives within Noun makes nominal projection inherited and brings the determinative, common-noun and proper-noun uses of cardinals within one primary category.

Section 2.2 compares the alternatives; §§3–6 develop the classification. The matched fragment in §7.2 then assesses its structural consequences and costs, holding judgments and lexical restrictions fixed. Any economy depends on the resulting grammar, including modifier and use restrictions.

2 CLASSIFICATION, HEADEDNESS AND FUNCTION

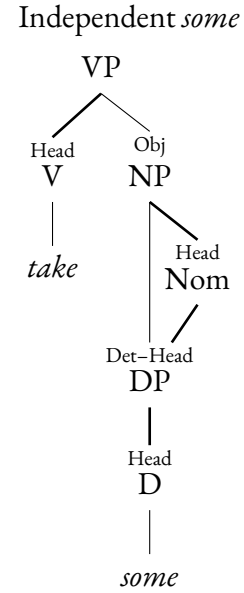
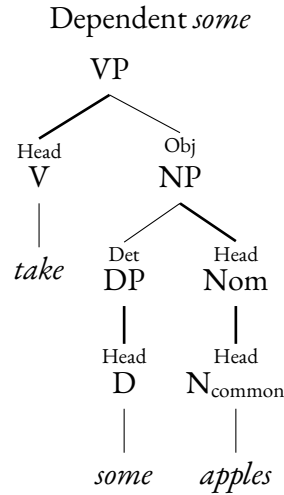
2.1 CATEGORY, FUNCTION AND PHRASE STRUCTURE

Lexical categories and syntactic functions cut across one another. An NP can function as determiner, as in *Kim's book*, and a determinative-headed phrase can function as modifier, as in *the many people* (Payne et al., 2010; Pullum & Miller, 2022).

The question of lexical classification is distinct from the headedness question associated with the DP hypothesis of Abney (1987). Under that hypothesis, D heads expressions such as *some apples*. I retain noun-headed NPs and reject the DP analysis for English, following the arguments of Pullum and Miller (2022) and Bruening (2020).

Category membership doesn't remove lexical restrictions. *Every apple* is grammatical, but **I'll take every* isn't an ordinary way to accept apples. The fragment retains that restriction (§7.2).

CGEL



D-noun analysis

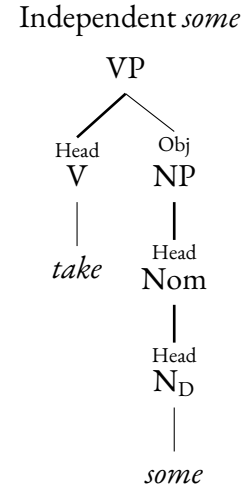
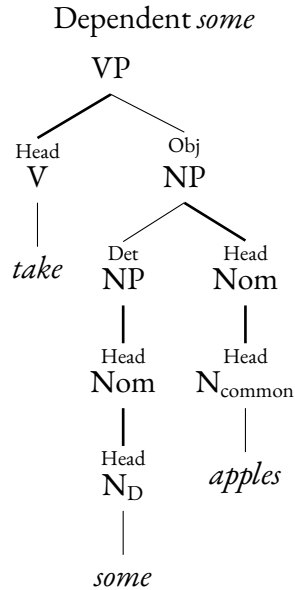


Figure 1: *Take some apples* (left) and *take some* (right) under CGEL (top) and the D-noun analysis (bottom). In the upper-right tree, DP fills Det of NP and Head of Nom. In the lower pair, *some* heads an NP through the same nominal projection; that NP functions as Det on the left and Obj on the right. Function labels appear above category labels. Det marks determiner, Obj object, and Det-Head fusion; the two links show the combined functions. N, D and V mark noun, determinative and verb; NP, DP and VP mark their phrases. Subscripts identify noun subcategories.

2.2 TAXONOMIC AND STRUCTURAL ALTERNATIVES

Keeping a word in one category across dependent and independent uses leaves its taxonomic position open. As J. Lyons (1968, pp. 232–235) observes, distribution can be compared at different levels of categorization: two expressions may belong together at one level and differ at a more specific level. Table 1 distinguishes the selected authors' proposals, their analytical levels and several logical alternatives. The D-noun analysis differs from *CGEL* by including determinative within Noun, and from Hudson by placing it alongside pronoun.

Table 1: Selected accounts and logical alternatives. The earlier proposals differ in scope and representational level; they don't all specify a surface taxonomy. The prose gives sources and inventory qualifications.

Account	Proposed relationship	Level or status
Palmer	Determinative adjectives grouped with pronouns.	Lexical grouping; inclusive Noun unspecified
Postal	Personal pronouns analysed as articles, with deeper noun features.	Intermediate and underlying representations
Sommerstein	Definite article and personal pronouns given NP structure.	Underlying representation
Lyons	Articles, demonstratives and personal pronouns linked by definiteness and deixis.	Semantic relationship
<i>CGEL</i>	Pronoun within Noun; determinative separate.	Lexical taxonomy
Hudson	Determiners within pronoun, which is within noun.	Lexical taxonomy
Spinillo	Determinatives redistributed; <i>the</i> , <i>a</i> and <i>every</i> retained as articles.	Lexical reclassification
D-noun analysis	Common noun, proper noun, pronoun and determinative coordinate within Noun.	Proposed taxonomy
Logical alternative	Noun, pronoun and determinative separate.	For comparison
Logical alternative	Determinative within Noun; pronoun separate.	For comparison
Logical alternative	Pronoun within determinative, which is within Noun.	For comparison
Logical alternative	Pronoun within proper noun; determinative within common noun.	For comparison

Palmer (1924, p. 24) proposed placing “determinative adjectives” with pronouns. He contrasted them with qualifying adjectives, which permit predicative use, comparison and adverbial modification, and emphasized most determinatives’ ability to “be used indifferently as pronouns or as mod-

ifiers of nouns”. J. Lyons (1968, p. 279) adds a semantic connection: articles, demonstratives and personal pronouns share definiteness and deictic contrasts.

Postal (1966) develops the article–pronoun connection through English reflexives and combinations such as *we men*. His morphological evidence for the noun *self* includes *selfish*, *selfless* and the plural alternation *self/selves*; he analyses the preceding pronominal material as an article. The classification depends on representational level: article segments occur at intermediate stages, their deepest counterparts are features of nouns, and surface pronouns can receive derivative Noun status.

Sommerstein (1972, pp. 197–203) argues in the opposite direction, giving the definite article and personal pronouns underlying NP structure. His English comparison includes the count restriction on anaphoric *one*, whereas *it* can refer to a quantity of a substance.³ He also observes that noun status for *self* doesn’t decide whether the preceding element is an article or a genitive pronoun.

These predecessors challenge a fundamental article–pronoun separation, but leave the full determinative inventory unclassified. Its contrasts in grade, modification, complementation and restricted independent use extend the comparison beyond their proposals.

Hudson makes taxonomic inclusion explicit. His noun category contains common noun, proper noun and pronoun (Hudson, 2010, pp. 253–254); a determiner is a pronoun whose VALENCY permits the relevant common-noun dependent (Hudson, 2004, pp. 9–10). The word’s category remains constant across independent and dependent uses, which differ in their permitted dependents.

Hudson’s criteria are also limited: they centre on licensing a singular count common noun and on mutual exclusion in that use. He sets aside *all*, cardinal numerals and quantifiers restricted to plural or non-count nouns (Hudson, 2004, pp. 9–10). These exclusions leave a substantial part of CGEL’s inventory outside his target grouping. Extending the pronoun analysis to that inventory requires comparing its modifier selection, grade and quantitative meanings with the properties of the existing pronouns.

Hudson also permits mutual dependency between determiner and common noun, with different constructions selecting different external heads (Hudson, 2004, pp. 7–12). His English temporal adjunct *We met that day* supports a common-noun head because the adjunct’s distribution depends on *day*’s temporal meaning. The D-noun analysis retains common-noun headedness in *that day* while changing the determining word’s superordinate category.

Spinillo (2004) instead proposes redistributing determinatives among existing categories, with *the*, *a* and *every* retained as an expanded article category. This isolates three members without ordinary independent use while assigning the others elsewhere. In particular, isolating *every* requires weighing that restriction against the quantitative and modifier properties it shares with other determinatives (§6).

For demonstratives and forms such as *some* and *all*, Spinillo (2004, pp. 140–144) compares dependent and independent uses with verbs and prepositions occurring with or without a complement. The analogy supports keeping a word’s category stable across uses. It doesn’t select that category or explain the full pattern of permitted dependents. CGEL, Hudson and the D-noun analysis can all preserve category continuity while disagreeing about classification.

³ Payne et al. (2013, pp. 797–798) analyse anaphoric *one* as a common count noun, distinct from determinative *one* and personal pronoun *one*.

3 THE D-NOUN ANALYSIS

3.1 THE BASIS FOR A BROADER NOUN CATEGORY

Table 2 compares external and internal syntax, semantics and morphology across the four proposed noun subcategories. Their shared properties occur in different combinations, with systematic differences among subcategories and restrictions on individual members.

Table 2: Representative profiles of the proposed noun subcategories. Entries describe ranges of behaviour, not properties of every member. External syntax concerns whole phrases; the competing analyses differ over their internal heads. Noun-forming suffixes are listed by their bases, without assuming that noun output establishes noun input. Sources and qualifications follow.

Dimension	Common noun	Proper noun	Pronoun	Determinative
Inventory	Open	Open to new names	Closed	Closed
External syntax	NP argument functions; genitive Det	NP argument functions; genitive Det	NP argument functions; genitive Det	NP argument functions; Det as in <i>some books</i> , <i>someone's books</i>
Meaning	Descriptive properties and relations	Naming in primary uses	Mainly deixis and anaphora	Quantification, definiteness and deixis
Pro-form gender	Descriptions contribute to referent construal	Names identify referents construed by gender	Contrasts expressed by gender-sensitive pro-forms	Contrasts expressed by gender-sensitive pro-forms
Inflection	Number and genitive	Genitive; restricted number	Case, including genitive; reflexive forms	Number; grade; genitive, e.g. <i>something's</i>
Noun-forming suffixes	<i>-ship: friendship</i>	<i>-er: Londoner</i>	No parallel established here	<i>-ness: nothingness</i>
Determination	Broad contrasts; singular count arguments normally require it	Restricted in primary naming uses	Normally excluded	Lexically restricted; <i>the few, these three</i>
Internal modification	Productive; usually AdjP premodifiers; relative postmodifiers	Restricted embellishments	Restricted: <i>poor old me</i> ; relative postmodifiers	AdvP premodifiers; NP-internal postmodifiers; <i>the lucky few</i>
Complementation	Selected PPs and clauses	Not characteristic of primary naming uses	Normally absent	Partitive <i>of</i> -PPs; comparative <i>than</i> -phrases

Meaning and reference vary within Noun. *Apple* conveys a descriptive classification; *Kim*, in its primary naming use, identifies through a name; *she* supplies limited descriptive content and depends on context. Determinatives range from deictic *this* to quantitative *many* and universal *every* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 358–360, 370–405, 425–428, 515–521). Their semantic affinities cross several boundaries: deixis connects demonstratives with pronouns, while quantity connects determinatives with common nouns such as *number* and *majority*.

Pro-form gender connects these ways of referring. Descriptions such as *the woman* and names such as *Kim* identify referents whose construal bears on pro-form choice. Gender-sensitive pronouns and determinatives express the relevant contrasts: compare personal *she* and *somebody* with non-personal *it* and *something* (Reynolds, 2025).

The semantic distance can be considerable. *Every* contributes a quantificational relation between a nominal restriction and what's predicated of its members; *Kim* identifies an individual through a name.

External syntax supplies a broad overlap in the functions available to the phrases. *CGEL* makes this the stated ground for including pronouns within Noun (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 327). A range of determinatives likewise occurs in subject, object and complement-of-preposition positions without another overt nominal head. The examples in §4.1 compare these uses across all four proposed subcategories.

Shared functions leave systematic distributional differences. In *Who did you see?*, interrogative *who* precedes the inverted auxiliary. Substituting *the vicar* doesn't preserve the open interrogative. A common-noun-headed phrase needs an interrogative constituent, as in *which vicar*. Both expressions have object function, but the construction also requires interrogative properties (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, Ch. 10, §§7.1, 7.9).

Adjectival constructions such as *the rich* also fill nominal argument positions, so external functions alone don't establish nounhood. Internal syntax extends the comparison: determinatives permit partitive complements, as in *some of the wine*, and comparative complements, as in *more than ten* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 392–394, 411–412, 432–433).

Common nouns permit PPs and clauses, while pronouns and primary naming uses of proper nouns have much more restricted dependents (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 429–430, 439–443, 517–521). Determinatives share parts of both profiles: restricted determination and modification coexist with nominal complement and postmodifier constructions. Section 3.3 examines their distinctive premodifiers, and §4.4 compares the resulting profile with adjectives.

Inflection supplies overlapping contrasts too. Common nouns inflect for number and genitive; proper nouns permit number distinctions in restricted uses. Pronouns distinguish case, including genitive, and reflexive forms. Within determinative, *this/these* shows number, *few/fewer/fewest* grade, and *something's* genitive (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 373, 423–424, 426, 479–480, 521). Number and case connect parts of the inventory with nouns; grade connects another part with adjectives.

CGEL treats singular and plural *you* as distinct lexemes whose difference is overt only in the reflexive forms *yourself* and *yourselves* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 486). Here number distinguishes lexemes rather than inflectional forms of one lexeme.

The adjectival affinities likewise vary across the inventory. Grade connects *few*, *many*, *much* and *little* with adjectives, and their comparative forms take *than*-complements. Predicative use extends

to *several*, and AdvP premodification extends much further. Even the gradable forms have distinct syntax: *so many mistakes* contrasts with **so numerous mistakes* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 392–396, 539–540).

Determinatives' nominal connections are distributed across the proposed subcategories: deixis and pro-form gender link them with pronouns, number and genitive marking with common and proper nouns, and argument and determiner uses with all three. Alongside partitives and nominal postmodification, I give this combined pattern greater weight than the adjectival connections. I therefore include determinatives within Noun, with their quantificational, inflectional and modifier patterns distinguishing the subcategory.

The D-noun analysis captures shared properties through INHERITANCE: a property stated for a superordinate category is available to its subcategories, subject to stated restrictions. Determinatives therefore inherit nominal projection from Noun. Subcategory rules constrain combinatorics, and lexical entries distinguish such forms as independent *some* and dependent-only *every*.

3.2 NOUN PHRASES IN DETERMINER AND ARGUMENT FUNCTIONS

Determinatives' characteristic determiner use could support a separate primary category. But Det is itself specific to NP structure, where it marks definiteness and often contributes quantification (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 354–359). These tasks connect it with the reference and number properties compared above. The question is whether this specialization warrants a primary boundary within nominal grammar.

Determiner function already cuts across the existing noun subcategories. Compare *my preferences*, *Kim's preferences* and *people's preferences*. The determiner is an NP ultimately headed by a pronoun, a proper noun and a common noun respectively (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 354–355, 470–471).⁴ Figure 2 illustrates the proper-noun case.

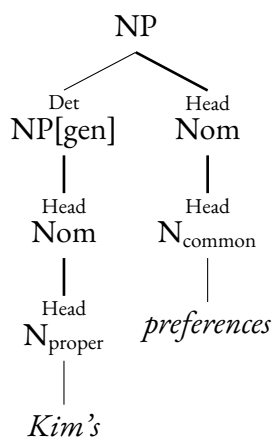


Figure 2: The genitive NP *Kim's* functions as determiner within *Kim's preferences*, ultimately headed by *preferences*. The representation abstracts from the internal realization of genitive marking.

⁴CGEL assigns these genitives the combined function Subject–Det (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 472–473). I treat them as Det here, without the additional subject function.

The compound determinative *someone*, following the classification of Payne et al. (2007, §1.3), joins this pattern in *someone's preferences*: its genitive NP fills the same determiner function. The nominal base in *someone* may contribute to that permission, and most determinatives resist case marking.

The NP headed by *some* likewise functions as Det in *take some apples* and as object in *take some* (Figure 1). Its subcategory and nominal projection remain constant across these uses.

NP becomes the shared phrase type for the principal realizations of determiner function. Plain determinatives, including modified forms such as *almost ten*, join genitives such as *Kim's* and *my*. Minor determiners include further NPs: *what size* in *what size shoes*, *that size* in *that size shoes*, and *Sunday* in *Sunday morning* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 356).

These existing NP determiners give the extension a functional basis. In *Kim's preferences*, the embedded NP supplies an identifying anchor through its own referent; *Sunday* and *what size* specify a day or a dimension. Determinatives' deictic and quantitative specifications fit this nominal pattern. I take that fit to support treating their specialization in Det as a distinction within Noun.

PPs remain a restricted alternative, as in *up to twenty minutes* and *between fifty and sixty tanks* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 356). Number, countability and other selectional conditions distinguish the determining expressions.

3.3 MODIFIER SELECTION AND TAXONOMIC LEVEL

Shared nominal projection doesn't make modifier permissions uniform. In *almost every experienced teacher* (Figure 3), the AdvP *almost* modifies the determinative noun *every*; the AdjP *experienced* modifies the common noun *teacher*, which ultimately heads the outer NP.

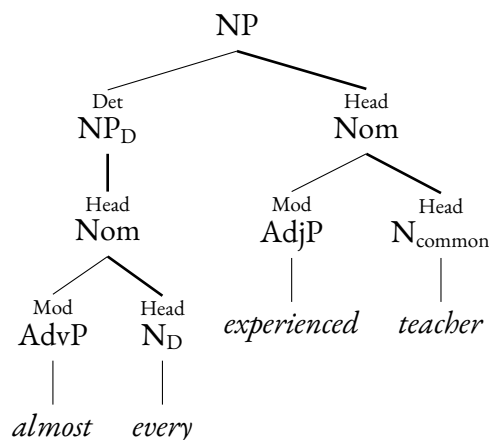


Figure 3: Two modifier relations in *almost every experienced teacher*: *almost* modifies *every*, and *experienced* modifies *teacher*. The outer NP has *teacher* as its ultimate head. Internal structure within the one-word modifier phrases is suppressed.

Payne et al. (2010, pp. 40–42) defend keeping *few*, *any* and related forms in one lexical category across dependent and independent uses. In *hardly any money* and independent *hardly any*, *hardly* remains an adverb and *any* retains its category. The D-noun analysis preserves that continuity. It

also preserves their contrast between adverbial premodification, as in *almost anybody*, and adjectival postmodification, as in *nothing absolute*.

The systematic use of AdvP premodifiers is the strongest internal-syntactic objection to the D-noun analysis. In the other three noun subcategories, internal premodifiers are normally adjectival or nominal. Adverbs occurring before a whole NP, as in *only you*, are peripheral modifiers of the NP, rather than internal modifiers of its head (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 430–431).

Payne et al. (2010, pp. 42–47) establish that adverbs can postmodify common nouns, and they analyse *almost* as modifying the attributive noun *textbook* in *an almost textbook case* (Payne et al., 2010, p. 75, n. 3). Adverbial modification therefore isn't categorically excluded from Noun. But neither postmodification nor a restricted attributive use removes the systematic contrast between *hardly any* or *almost every* and ordinary common-noun premodification.

Postmodifier permissions vary within Noun too. Common nouns freely take integrated relative clauses; personal pronouns permit a restricted range, including *we who have read the report* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 430). Compound determinatives permit them too, as in *something that you need to know* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 423–424).

Including determinatives places the premodifier contrast within Noun. The determinative subcategory licenses *hardly any* and *almost every*; common nouns license *experienced teacher*. Neither **experienced every* nor **almost teacher* follows. This contrast weighs against the grouping; §7.3 examines its consequences for stating the rules.

3.4 WORD FORMATION AND CATEGORY BOUNDARIES

Noun-forming suffixes differ in the bases they select. *-ship* in *friendship* primarily selects nouns denoting persons, though *hardship* has an adjective base. The inhabitant suffix *-er* in *Londoner* attaches to a place name (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, Ch. 19, §§5.6.2(b), 5.7.2(k)). Table 2 establishes no noun-selecting suffix shared by pronouns and determinatives.

Determinatives enter derivations whose output is a common noun. *CGEL* cites *nothingness* and *oneness* among formations with *-ness* on non-adjectival bases (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, Ch. 19, §5.7.2(i)). Further established nouns include *thisness*, *fewness* and *muchness*.⁵

-ness is the default suffix for forming nouns from adjectives, but also attaches to other bases, as in *whyness* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, Ch. 19, §5.7.2(i)). It therefore doesn't settle the input category of *nothingness*. A conversion analysis would require independent evidence for an intermediate base.

The adverb *mostly* provides a different output.⁶ Adverbial *-ly* primarily attaches to adjectives, but *CGEL* also gives noun-based *partly* and *purposely* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 566). This gives *most* an adjectival affinity without an adjective-only diagnostic.

Pronouns enter gender-marking compounds such as *he-goat* and *she-ass* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, Ch. 19, §5.3); determinatives combine with nominal material in *someone* and *anything*. Their determinative premodifier permissions recur in the compounds (§4.5), while the nominal component contributes further properties.

⁵See *Merriam-Webster.com Dictionary*, s.vv. *thisness* and *fewness*, and *Dictionary.com*, s.v. *muchness* (accessed 10 September 2026). These attestations don't establish a uniformly productive modern rule.

⁶See *Dictionary.com*, s.v. *mostly* (accessed 10 September 2026).

Numeral morphology extends the comparison to ordinal and fractional formations, analysed respectively as adjectival and nominal by Reynolds (2026). Their formation also bears on the boundary between a numeral lexeme and a syntactic phrase.

Morphology supplies mixed evidence: number and genitive marking give the clearest inflectional connections with nouns, while grade gives an adjectival connection. Derivation links some determinatives with common nouns through suffixes whose typical bases are adjectival.

4 EVIDENCE FOR NOMINAL STRUCTURE

Independent uses, partitives and modification show a recurring nominal pattern. The observations overlap: *Some left* illustrates both external distribution and syntactic completeness. Fusion and ordinary headedness offer different internal analyses of these constructions.

4.1 BREADTH OF INDEPENDENT USE

Independent use is widespread within the determinative inventory. *CGEL* discusses such uses for demonstratives and quantifiers including *some*, *all*, *both*, *many*, *few*, *several*, *each*, *either*, *neither*, *much* and *enough*, while recording lexical restrictions and the separate forms *no/none* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 371–372, 410–424). The generalization concerns the availability of independent constructions across a lexical category, not unrestricted acceptability in every sentence frame.⁷

In the constructed examples in (1), compare the bracketed NPs as subjects, objects and complements of prepositions. Assume that a woman named Kim and a group of people are already under discussion. The competing analyses assign different internal structures to independent *some*.

- (1) a. [*People*] left. I see [*people*]. with [*people*]
 b. [*Kim*] left. I see [*Kim*]. with [*Kim*]
 c. [*She*] left. I see [*her*]. with [*her*]
 d. [*Some*] left. I see [*some*]. with [*some*]

Adjectival independent uses prevent a simple inference from these positions to nounhood. *The rich* and *the poor* can fill nominal argument positions. Comparative and superlative adjectives also head expressions without a human-class interpretation: *CGEL's the most important of her criticisms* is an NP containing a partitive *of*-phrase (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 332–333, 416–423).

Independent *some* can form a one-word NP, whereas an NP with *rich* as fused head normally requires a determiner on the human-class reading. That is a local contrast: argument NPs headed by singular count common nouns also need determination. Section 4.4 returns to the fuller adjectival comparison.

⁷Material before a determiner falls outside the independent-use comparison. *CGEL* treats *all/both* in *all/both the books* as predeterminer modifiers, *quite/rather* before *a good idea* as peripheral modifiers, and *such*/exclamative *what* before *a disaster* as adjectives (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 433–437). The fixed *many a* is a complex determinative restricted to Det function (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 394). The *half* in *half a cake* is a common noun used as a predeterminer modifier (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 434). These constructions don't add evidence for independent determinative heads.

4.2 STRUCTURAL SATURATION AND INTERPRETATION

With a group of people under discussion, *Some left*, *Many came* and *All agree* illustrate STRUCTURAL SATURATION: an argument expression can be syntactically complete without another overt head or determiner. Syntactic completeness differs from contextual interpretation. In *I'll take some*, the relevant substance or set may be supplied by discourse or the situation. That dependence doesn't establish a deleted common noun: ordinary pronouns also depend on context.

In the following attestation from the CGELBank treebank, *two different Honda models* supplies the domain for the independent object *both*:⁸

- (2) *Went there yesterday: we are trying to decide between two different Honda models, so we wanted to test-drive both back to back.*

Generalizing expressions such as *Many are called*, *few are chosen* and *Enough is enough* need no previously uttered common-noun phrase. They rule out a mandatory overt-antecedent requirement, but a silent-noun account could supply a generic restriction. Such examples don't decide whether the restriction belongs in semantics or syntax.

The comparison with ordinary pronouns and proper nouns is structural as well as interpretive. In *She left* and *Kim left*, CGEL permits an NP headed by a nominal with no determiner. Applying that structure to *Some left* preserves the same division between a complete NP and its context-dependent reference. The dependent use of *some* doesn't by itself require a Det function inside every independent occurrence.

In Payne et al. (2007), one constituent jointly realizes Head and a dependent function, subject to structural and adjacency conditions. Under CGEL's analysis of independent *some*, its DP fills Det of NP and Head of Nom. The word remains determinative, while the independent expression is an NP. Ordinary headedness instead gives *some* nominal projection, with the same restrictions on independence and form selection.

CGEL also uses fusion with nouns. It assigns anaphoric *mine* to Det–Head, but predicative possessive *mine*, as in *it's mine*, to pure Head (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 410–411). Nounhood is thus compatible with fusion. Here ordinary determinative headedness follows from the inherited projection rules; the analysis of independent genitives, including *Kim's* and *mine*, falls outside the fragment in §7.2.

4.3 PARTITIVES LOCATE THE QUANTIFICATIONAL HEAD

In *some of the wine*, *some* specifies a quantity drawn from an identifiable amount of wine. The NP *the wine* denotes the partitive DOMAIN: the whole from which that quantity is drawn. This NP is complement of *of*. A pronoun-headed NP or independent genitive NP can express the domain too: *many of them*, referring to previously mentioned people, or *some of Kim's*, referring to Kim's apples.

Compare where the common noun occurs in *some apples* and *some of the wine*. In the partitive, *wine* is embedded inside the *of*-phrase, so it can't be the lexical head of the whole NP. The comparison instead concerns the head-like role of *some* in that larger expression.

Figure 4 gives the D-noun analysis, with the *of*-phrase functioning as complement within Nom, as in CGEL's partitive tree (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 411–412). CGEL represents the head-like role of *some* through Det–Head fusion. Partitives support that role while leaving the choice between fusion and ordinary headedness open.

⁸CGELBank (Reynolds et al., 2023), sentence reviews-083459-0002.

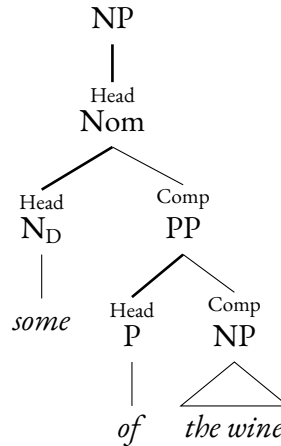


Figure 4: *Some of the wine* under the D-noun analysis. The Head relations lead from the outer NP to *some*. The common noun *wine* is inside the complement PP and doesn't head the whole expression. The inner NP is abbreviated.

The overt quantifier and domain already supply a compositional interpretation of *some of the wine*. A silent common noun would need to explain something further, such as a restriction on interpretation or modification that the overt-head account misses. The construction itself supplies no such requirement. I therefore prefer an overt-head analysis over an otherwise equivalent null-head analysis; fusion remains compatible with that preference.

4.4 MODIFICATION TESTS THE INTERNAL ANALYSIS

The pair *the lucky survivors/the lucky few* supplies a comparison involving both external determination and adjectival modification. *CGEL* explicitly permits determinatives used as internal modifiers to fuse with Head, as in *the other two* and *these few here* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 415–416). Its analysis of *the few mistakes* assigns *the* to Det and *few* to Mod (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 392). That dependent use supplies the counterpart for a Mod–Head analysis of independent *few* after an external determiner.

Figure 5 compares the resulting analyses of *the lucky few*. Both have an overt Det and a Nom modified by *lucky*. In the D-noun analysis, *few* fills Head. In the fusion analysis, its DP fills Mod–Head. The competing structure thus uses machinery already needed for adjectival fusion; it requires neither a silent noun nor conversion.

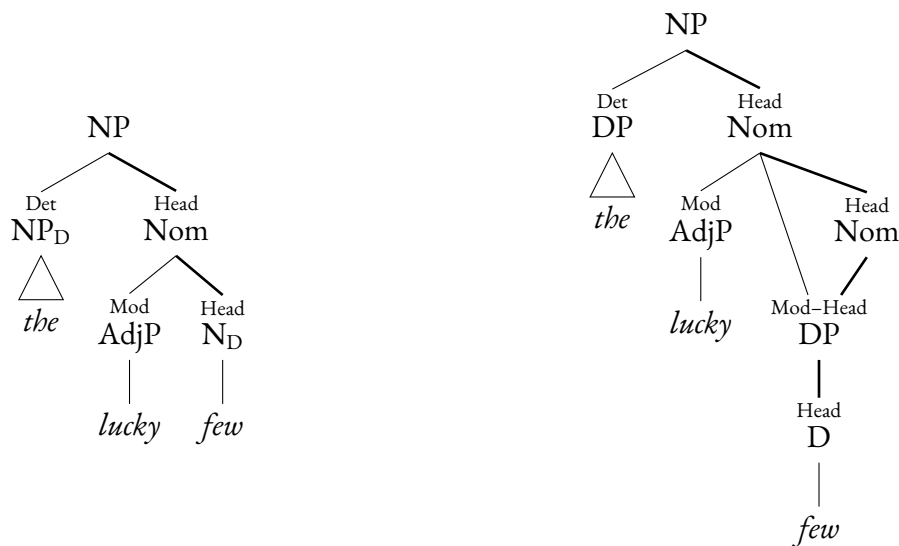


Figure 5: *The lucky few* with ordinary Head (left) and Mod-Head fusion (right). The determiner is separately realized in both. Internal structure within the article phrase and AdjP is suppressed.

Table 3 compares the Head relations across four constructions; §7.2 supplies the rules under both taxonomies.

Table 3: Head and dependent functions under matched analyses. Each independent expression is an NP; *the* fills Det wherever it appears. The ordinary-Head column applies to both taxonomies permitting ordinary determinative heads.

Expression	Separate D with fusion	Ordinary determinative Head
<i>few survivors</i>	<i>few</i> : Det; <i>survivors</i> : Head	Same functions
Independent <i>few</i>	<i>few</i> : Det-Head	<i>few</i> : Head
<i>the lucky few</i>	<i>few</i> : Mod-Head; <i>lucky</i> : Mod	<i>few</i> : Head; <i>lucky</i> : Mod
<i>the idle rich</i>	<i>rich</i> : Mod-Head; <i>idle</i> : Mod	Same fusion and modifier functions

Fusion groups *the lucky few* with *the idle rich*; ordinary headedness groups it with *the lucky survivors* and unifies bare and externally determined *few*. Both cover the example. The choice is between sharing fusion across D and adjective, and sharing ordinary Head structure across determinative constructions.

Reducing fusion's applications can simplify this description even when fusion remains available for adjectives. The advantage is the uniform treatment of *few*; its value depends on any additional conditions or lost generalizations elsewhere.⁹ Section 7.2 compares those costs while holding the lexical restrictions fixed.

⁹Compare the theory of second best in Lipsey and Lancaster (1956, pp. 11–12): under a constraint preventing an optimum, satisfying more optimality conditions needn't improve the outcome. The analogy concerns interactions among grammatical choices, not a formal optimum for the grammar.

The constructed *the remaining three* extends the modifier pattern to cardinals. It doesn't independently decide whether *three* is determinative or has a common-noun use: Reynolds (2026) argues for both uses of cardinals. Section 7.3 treats their unification as a consequence conditional on that analysis.

Relative-clause postmodification adds another nominal construction: *those who came*, *anyone who asks*, *everything that matters*, and, with books under discussion, *some that I saw*. CGEL describes relatives with demonstratives and compounds (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 414, 422–423). These clauses modify the nominal expression containing the determinative, as they do in *people who came*.

Number supplies a further distinction between determinatives and adjectives. Independent *this/these* and *that/those* retain overt singular–plural contrasts. The human-class *the rich*, by contrast, is a plural NP whose adjective lacks nominal number inflection and still takes adverb modifiers: *the very rich* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 418). The strongest morphological evidence comes from the demonstrative paradigms. The singular and plural specifications of *each* and *several* concern lexical restrictions; NP number alone doesn't distinguish the categories. Other determinatives, such as plural or non-count *some*, remain number-neutral.

Bare colour expressions and evaluative comparative subjects complicate a simple distributional boundary. CGEL's *Henrietta likes red shirts*, and *I like blue* permits colour-noun ambiguity as well as possible reduction licensed by coordination; the attested *Bluer is better* establishes a bare comparative subject without settling its phrase category.¹⁰ These cases leave the wider comparison of argument distribution and head properties necessary.

The combination of argument use, nominal number properties, partitives and modification favours ordinary determinative headedness alongside adjectival fusion.

4.5 COMPOUNDS AND MODIFIER DOMAINS

A more demanding modifier comparison is *hardly anyone present*. Payne et al. (2007, pp. 581–583) assign *hardly* to DP structure and *present* to nominal structure. The compound *anyone* takes the premodifiers of its determinative base *any*: compare *hardly any writer present*. The adjective realizes a specialized RESTRICTOR function, restricted to post-head position and non-recursive. Figure 6 contrasts this account with an ordinary-Head analysis.

¹⁰The *blue*, *old* and *small* examples on CGEL p. 417 all occur in coordinated contrasts. *Bluer is better* accompanies a results colour scale in Stanford CS329X, “Codeswitching LLMs”, slide 8 (accessed 10 September 2026). I interpret it as evaluating a degree of blueness. Subject function alone doesn't establish NP status (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 236).

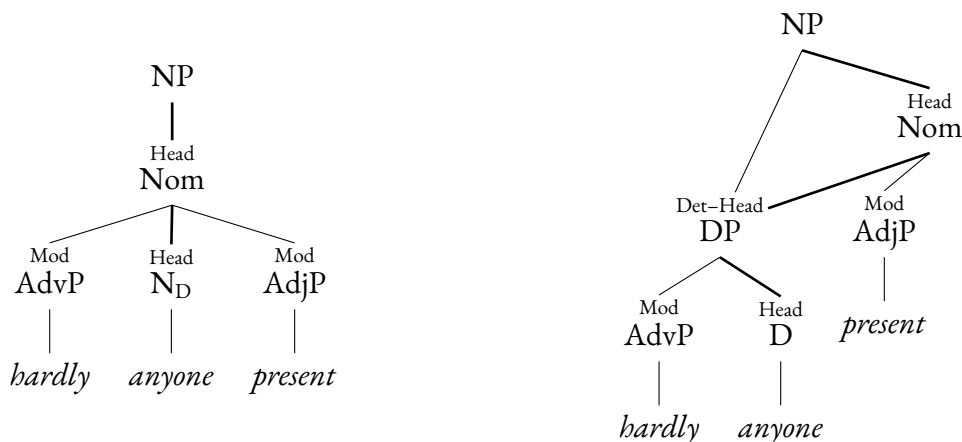


Figure 6: *Hardly anyone present* with ordinary Head (left) and fusion (right). Both post-head Mod positions realize the specialized restrictor. In the fusion tree, DP fills Det of NP and Head of Nom, following Payne et al. (2007, p. 582, (13d)). Modifier-phrase interiors are suppressed.

In the D-noun analysis, *anyone* inherits nominal projection from Noun and its premodifier permissions from its determinative base. The compound construction supplies the post-head restrictor permission, with the same position and non-recursion conditions as the fusion account. It doesn't license a corresponding pre-head adjective. The compound's ordinary argument use and exclusion of external determination are further lexical conditions; the premodifier and restrictor slots aren't unrestricted Nom dependents.

The relative clauses illustrated above are ordinary postmodifiers, distinct from the specialized restrictor. When both occur, the relative follows it: *something useful that I found*. CGEL explicitly gives compounds the common noun's range of ordinary postmodifiers while preserving this ordering condition (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 423).

This division extends to *someone* and *everybody*: the compound family licenses nominal argument use and post-head restrictors, while each base supplies its own premodifier permissions. CGELBank attests the post-head pattern in *I need something reliable and good looking*.¹¹

Fusion reuses the DP–Nom boundary to separate the two modifier domains. Ordinary headedness locates both within Nom, assigning their restrictions to the determinative base and compound construction. Both accounts need the specialized restrictor condition.

4.6 PREDICATIVE USES AND THEIR RESTRICTIONS

CGEL records predicative *Its advantages are several* and *Their enemies were many*, describing the latter pattern as uncommon and formal (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 392, 395–396). This use is available to only part of the determinative inventory; *every* and the articles remain excluded.

She is a doctor ascribes a property, whereas *That is Kim* identifies a person. CGEL excludes specifying *be* clauses from its noun–adjective diagnostic because phrases from other categories occur in them too (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 536).

Nominal grammar also distinguishes predicative and argument uses. A bare-role NP such as *president* is licensed in *I'd like to be president*, but requires determination in the corresponding object use

¹¹ Sentence `answers-20111024111513AAQhAO_ans-0003` in `ewt-test_iaa50.cgel`.

I'd like to meet the president (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 328). Determinatives' asymmetries fit this broader variation within Noun.

4.7 WHAT THE COMBINED PATTERN SUPPORTS

The nominal constructions reinforce the semantic and morphological connections in §3. Under the D-noun analysis, bare, partitive and externally determined uses inherit ordinary Head structure. *CGEL* distinguishes Det–Head from Mod–Head and uses the DP–Nom boundary to separate modifier domains. These are competing ways of organizing the same constructional evidence; their grammatical costs are compared in §7.2.

5 COORDINATE SUBCATEGORIES AND INHERITANCE

Should determinatives and pronouns be coordinate subcategories within Noun, or should determinatives belong inside pronoun? Reynolds (2021) compares determinative and pronoun profiles; its matrix contains no common or proper nouns. Distributional separation between the supplied groups doesn't determine their taxonomic rank or test the proposed superordinate category. The original discussion likewise leaves a nested nominal analysis open.

The accompanying audit reproduces the published DISCO decomposition, but the clustering outcome varies with initialization and feature selection.¹²

The pronoun inventory in that study follows *CGEL*'s classification, whereas Hudson's pronoun category includes the words he calls determiners. Comparing these hierarchies requires aligning their lexical inventories and asking which generalizations can be stated for each superordinate category.

Nesting would group pronouns and determinatives more closely than either with common or proper nouns. Reduced descriptive content and contextual interpretation are shared by many pronouns and determinatives. The coordinate analysis can record these interpretive properties through features or cross-classification; they don't by themselves require an intermediate lexical category.

Pro-form gender links pronouns and determinatives (§3.1). The personhood-based system also includes non-nominal expressions (Reynolds, 2025); it doesn't by itself decide between coordinate and nested noun subcategories.

Restrictions on determination and attributive modification provide syntactic candidates, but they also occur outside the proposed grouping. In their primary use, proper names don't select freely from the determiner system, and their adjectival embellishments are restricted (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 517, 519–520). These properties distinguish more than pronouns and determinatives from common nouns.

Determination also differs within the proposed intermediate category. Determinatives permit external determination in a range of independent quantificational constructions: *the few*, *the many*, *the two*, *these three*. The permissions vary by item and often require further modification; *CGEL* gives *these few here* and *the many who did* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 415–416). Pronouns admit external determination only marginally, and internal premodification is restricted, as in *poor old me* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 429–430). These restrictions thus cross-cut the proposed grouping and vary within it.

¹²The accompanying [Replication audit of the English determinative–pronoun feature matrix](#) documents the discrepancy between the reported 232 features and the public 155-feature file, an extra feature dropped by the published clustering code, and the sensitivity results. The archived public file is retained unchanged.

I place determinative alongside pronoun because their shared nominal properties coexist with different centres of grammatical organization. Pronouns centre on person, case, reflexivity and contextual reference; determinatives centre on quantification, determination and their associated modifier patterns. Their affinities with common and proper nouns also favour coordination.

6 THE ARTICLES AND OTHER RESTRICTED MEMBERS

Why classify the articles *the* and *a* as nouns if they can't stand independently? *Every* is restricted too, while *no* has the distinct independent form *none* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 371–372, 410–411).¹³

CGEL's treatment of *my* supplies a precedent for restricted membership within Noun (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 470–471). The pronoun's paradigm supports its membership despite its lack of *mine*'s independent distribution. For articles, the corresponding positive evidence is integration into determinative; their nounhood depends on the category-level argument.

The articles are integrated into determinative in three ways. First, they contrast with demonstratives and quantifiers before common-noun nominals: *the/a/this/every book*. Second, they participate in the same system of definiteness, number and count restrictions: *the* permits singular, plural and non-count targets, while *a* selects a singular count target. Third, their lack of ordinary independent uses leaves that determining pattern intact. These connections support determinative membership, rather than establishing nounhood independently.

Every has further connections beyond the restricted article set proposed by Spinillo (2004). Like *each*, it expresses universal quantification and selects singular count nominals: *every teacher, each teacher*. Unlike *each*, it lacks ordinary independent use. It also permits modification by *almost* and *nearly*. These connections support retaining *every* with the quantifiers.

The argument for retaining the articles is synchronic. Grammaticalization supplies background: C. Lyons (1999, pp. 331–336) discusses the development of definite articles from demonstratives and of articles expressing cardinality from numerals. These histories can explain changes in content and use, but don't establish the synchronic classification.

A separate article category would gain support from a cluster of synchronic restrictions shared by *the*, *a* and *every*, absent elsewhere in Noun and otherwise requiring repeated exceptions. Lack of independent argument use alone doesn't supply that cluster.

7 STRUCTURAL CONSEQUENCES AND GRAMMATICAL ECONOMY

7.1 A SHARED PHRASE TYPE IN DETERMINER FUNCTION

In *some apples* and *Kim's apples*, the determining phrases share the NP category under both ordinary-Head accounts: D-noun and separate D. *CGEL* instead distinguishes DP from genitive NP. It also admits a restricted range of plain-case NPs and PPs as determiners, as in *what size hat* and *over thirty ties* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, Ch. 5, §4). The phrase types are:

CGEL: Det : {DP, NP, PP}

Both ordinary-Head accounts: Det : {NP, PP}

¹³In *the bigger the better*, *CGEL* analyses *the* as a modifier within a comparative phrase (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 1131–1132, 1135–1136). This dependent use outside Det leaves the restriction on ordinary argument use intact.

This shares a phrase type without shortening the selectional disjunction: determinative-headed, genitive and other licensed NPs still require separate identification. *CGEL* already states definiteness and the single-Det restriction functionally, so reclassification doesn't derive them. The following fragment compares projection once those restrictions are held fixed.

7.2 A MATCHED DESCRIPTIVE FRAGMENT

A grammatical **FRAGMENT** is a set of rules for a specified range of constructions. Here it covers determination, ordinary subject and object uses, partitives, and the modifier and compound comparisons in §4. It compares the D-noun analysis with two separate-D alternatives: ordinary headedness and fusion. All receive the same lexical restrictions and constructed judgments. The predicative constructions in §4.6 fall outside the fragment.

Table 4 records **USE PERMISSIONS**: whether a form, on a given reading, can head a phrase in determiner, subject or object function. **ARGUMENT USE** covers the subject and object NPs in examples such as *Some left* and *I saw some*. Quotation, metalinguistic naming and subordinate-clause uses of dependent genitives fall outside the fragment. Noun membership doesn't itself grant a use permission.

Table 4: Shared permissions in the fragment. For *some*, the target column concerns its unstressed use before a noun. The inventory is deliberately limited to the displayed constructions.

Form	Det use	Argument use	Target in the Det construction
<i>the</i>	yes	no	Singular or plural; count or non-count
<i>a, every</i>	yes	no	Singular count nominal
<i>some</i>	yes	yes	Plural count or non-count nominal
<i>few</i>	yes	yes	Plural count nominal
<i>my</i>	yes	no	No number/count restriction in this fragment
<i>she</i>	no	yes	None

Further constructional restrictions apply: *she* is a subject form, whereas the corresponding ordinary object form is *her*. The target restrictions concern the common-noun nominal being determined: *a* requires a singular count target such as *book* in *a book*.

Table 5 locates the three accounts. Comparing the ordinary-Head accounts holds projection fixed while varying taxonomy. Comparing the separate-D accounts holds taxonomy fixed while varying headedness.

Table 5: Three accounts retaining the permissions in Table 4, the modifier restrictions and the compound conditions.

Account	Primary taxonomy	Simple independent determinative
D-noun analysis	D inside Noun	N–Nom–NP projection with Head function
Separate D, ordinary Head	D outside Noun	D–Nom–NP through cross-category projection
CGEL: separate D, fusion	D outside Noun	NP distribution through Det–Head

The D-noun analysis applies nominal projection to determinatives through their membership in Noun. A separate condition checks use permissions. In the schemata below, h identifies the lexical head throughout its projection; parentheses mark optional dependents. The subscripts on Mod distinguish pre-head and post-head positions of the same modifier function. The head’s entry and construction restrict every dependent.

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{Nom}_h &\rightarrow (\text{Mod}_{\text{pre}}) \text{ Head} : \text{N}_h \text{ (Comp)} \text{ (Mod}_{\text{post}}) \\
 \text{NP}_h &\rightarrow (\text{Det}) \text{ Head} : \text{Nom}_h \\
 \text{licensed}(\text{NP}_h, f, c) &\iff f \in U_h \wedge C_h(f, c)
 \end{aligned}$$

Here U_h is the head’s set of use permissions, f is the NP’s function, and C_h checks the lexical and constructional conditions in context c . For Det use, these include compatibility with the target nominal; for an argument headed by a singular count common noun, they include required determination. Optionality in the second rule doesn’t override those conditions.

In *some apples*, *some* heads an NP whose Det permission and plural-count target requirement are satisfied. *Apples* heads the outer Nom, which heads the NP. In *Some left*, *some* heads an NP whose argument permission is satisfied. *Every apple* passes the Det and singular-count checks; ordinary independent **Every arrived* fails the argument-permission check. *The apple* and **The arrived* differ in the same way.

Each NP’s use permissions follow its own head. In *the apple*, the article’s Det permission licenses the dependent NP headed by *the*. The outer NP takes its argument permission from *apple*, whose requirement for determination is satisfied by the article.

A singular count common noun such as *book* faces a different restriction from an article. In *a book*, its requirement for determination is satisfied; bare **Book arrived* leaves that requirement unsatisfied. *Books arrived* has no such requirement. Requiring determination for a common noun doesn’t itself block an article-headed NP from argument use. An article’s exclusion from argument use must still be stated separately.

Some and *few* permit a partitive *of*-phrase within their nominal projection. *Almost* can modify *every* in *almost every teacher*; that permission doesn’t license *experienced* as a modifier of *every*. The construction *the lucky few* permits the external determiner and adjectival modifier shown in Figure 5.

Keeping ordinary headedness while retaining primary D gives the strongest separate-D alternative. It retains the NP and use-permission rules, but replaces the lexical-head restriction in Nom with:

$$\text{Nom}_h \rightarrow (\text{Mod}_{\text{pre}}) \quad \text{Head} : \{N_h, D_h\} \quad (\text{Comp}) \quad (\text{Mod}_{\text{post}})$$

This projection applies to dependent as well as independent determinatives, eliminating DP from the fragment while retaining primary D. Determiner selection still identifies D-headed NPs and suitable genitives. In *the lucky few*, *few* is D in ordinary Head function. In *hardly anyone present*, the determinative base and compound construction supply the same modifier restrictions as the D-noun account. Adjectival Mod–Head fusion remains available in both.

The separate-D fusion account relates independent determinatives to their dependent counterparts. In addition to nominal projection for nouns, it uses DP projection and permits a DP to realize a fused function in nominal structure. The partitive complement and compound restrictor belong to Nom, following the trees in *CGEL* and Payne et al. (2007, p. 582):

$$\begin{aligned} \text{DP}_h &\rightarrow (\text{Mod}_{\text{pre}}) \quad \text{Head} : D_h \quad (\text{Comp}) \\ \text{Nom}_h &\rightarrow (\text{Mod}_{\text{pre}}) \quad F : \text{DP}_h \quad (\text{Comp}) \quad (\text{Mod}_{\text{post}}) \\ F &\in \{\text{Det–Head}, \text{Mod–Head}\} \end{aligned}$$

The ordinary NP rule embeds this Nom. Det–Head jointly realizes Det of NP and Head of Nom, excluding a second Det; Mod–Head fills an internal modifier’s function and Head of Nom, allowing external determination. Lexical and constructional conditions select the fused function and permitted dependents. These schemata cover independent *few*, *few of them*, *the lucky few* and *hardly anyone present*.

The ordinary-Head accounts thus share nominal projection and Head relations; these benefits don’t uniquely favour inclusion within Noun. Dependent determinatives acquire a Nom layer in both. The taxonomic difference lies in whether the lexical head enters this structure by inheritance from Noun or by a rule admitting both N and D.

A grammar with Hudson’s nested classification can use the same permissions and projection rules. Holding those rules fixed, placing the broader pronoun category on determinative’s inheritance path from Noun leaves the fragment’s judgments unchanged.

7.3 EXISTING RESTRICTIONS, ADDITIONAL COSTS AND CONSEQUENCES

Common nouns, proper nouns and pronouns already differ in determination and permitted modifiers (Table 2). Preserving those conditions adds no cost to the D-noun analysis. Separate D likewise restricts adverbial modification and independent use within its own category; moving those restrictions inside Noun doesn’t create them.

The premodifier contrast in §3.3 adds a cost. A restriction normally stated for primary Noun now applies to specified noun subcategories, while determinatives retain their adverbial premodifiers. The attributive *almost textbook* exception qualifies the original generalization. Compound constructions also retain the distinction between inherited premodifier permissions and post-head restrictors (§4.5).

Further constructions could favour inheritance by reusing nominal rules, or separate D if its boundary captures recurring restrictions otherwise restated within Noun. A fair comparison holds the inventory, constructions and readings fixed.

Reynolds (2026) distinguishes determinative uses such as *ten men*, proper-noun uses such as *Room 101*, and common-noun uses such as *tens of pens*. Under the D-noun analysis, all fall within primary Noun, retaining their subcategory and constructional differences. Ordinals remain adjectives, and complex numeral phrases remain distinct from single lexemes.

Complex cardinals also separate category from function. In *two hundred books*, the whole *two hundred* fills Det; internally, *two* modifies the magnitude head *hundred* (Reynolds, 2026, §4). In *these two hundred books*, *these* fills Det and *two hundred* is an internal modifier. One Det function doesn't entail a limit of one determinative lexeme per NP.

If determinative-headed and genitive expressions require different projection rules after their independently motivated restrictions are held fixed, the shared-projection proposal in §7.1 loses its advantage. That would favour separate phrase types. Retaining a separate primary D requires the further case that the category boundary captures the recurring differences better than a determinative subcategory within Noun.

8 CONCLUSION

I propose four coordinate subcategories of Noun in English: common noun, proper noun, pronoun and determinative. Their overlapping semantic, syntactic and morphological profiles justify the grouping, while determinatives' quantificational, inflectional and modifier patterns distinguish their subcategory. Its restricted members, including the articles, belong through their integration into the determinative paradigm.

Determinatives inherit nominal projection and ordinary Head relations across bare, partitive and externally determined uses. This brings the principal realizations of determiner function within NP and cardinal uses within one primary category. Separate-D grammars can share some of these structures; comparative economy remains a further consideration alongside the broader grammatical profile.

DATA AND ANALYSIS MATERIALS

The accompanying supplements are [Replication audit of the English determinative-pronoun feature matrix](#) and [CGELBank concordance and extraction notes](#). The analysis/ directory preserves their input files, provenance records, scripts, numerical outputs and sentence concordance. Its README identifies the files and reproduction procedures.

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